Fr. Patrick Doherty 79642496 / Fr. Kieran O'Doherty 79642359
Sacristans: Glen 79643131/Maghera 79643061 Web Cam www.mcnmedia.live
Baptisms: 79642983(Notification by Thursday) Pastoral Centre:79642983
Pilgrim Statue: 79642983 / St Vincent de Paul Helpline: 07752111032
PARISH FACEBOOK PAGE – www.facebook.com/magheraparish
It's a useful way to stay up to date with all our parish events. Please hit the 'Follow' button and we would be grateful if you could like and share our posts.

Sunday:	St Patrick's	9.30am
	St Mary's	Vigil 6.30am and Sunday 11.30am
		Wednesday 7.30pm and Friday 10.00am
Daily Mass	St Patrick's	Monday to Thursday 9.30am
		Friday 7.30pm (Mass for all deceased)
		Daily Rosary at 9.10am

CONFESSIONS :– Daily after Morning Mass (except Sunday and Holydays) & St Mary's at 7pm on Wednesday (before Evening Mass) and Saturday 11am/12Noon & 5.30pm/6.15pm

During this month of November let us pray for the deceased priests who served our diocese and our parishes as we pray for the men who will take up their mantle in the years to come.

Rev. Pat O'Hagan

There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood in Derry today **Sunday 8 November, beginning at 4pm**. *For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr. Pat O'Hagan at pgoh2111@gmail.com or by calling (028)79386259*

Rev. Pat O'Hagan

HOLY FACE OF JESUS: – Prayers every Tuesday after 9.30am Mass and Divine Mercy.

OUR LADY UNTIER OF KNOTS NOVENA: - Continues in St Mary's Church on Wednesday evening 11 November after 7.30pm Mass.

ANNUAL MASS FOR DECEASED: The 7.30pm Mass in Glen next Friday 13 November will be offered for the dead and especially for all in our parish who died from 13 November 25 to Friday 13 November 26. **A book of Enrolment for all our deceased will be on the Sanctuary of each church during the month of November.**

BEST WISHES *to Fr. Patrick Lagan who will be installed as Parish Priest of Greencastle next Saturday 14 November at 7.30pm and as Parish Priest of Gortin on Saturday 21 Nov at 7.30pm.*

ANAMCARA DONEGAL, the organisation that supports bereaved parents, will hold its monthly Face to Face Parent Support Evening for bereaved parents on Thurs 12 November at 7.30pm in the Raddison Blu Hotel, Letterkenny This event is Free and open to all bereaved parents regardless of the age of their child. We also offer online support group meetings. email info@anamcara.ie

ENVELOPE COLLECTION: - Thank you for last week's envelope collections of £3,398.00 We appreciate your support to the church and for bringing your envelopes and donations to the church and pastoral centre. May your generosity be rewarded. Anyone wishing to donate to Maghera parish may do so by visiting website: magheraparishderry.com

FEASTS THIS WEEK Monday: St Leo the Great, pope and doctor of the church
Tuesday: St Martin of Tours, bishop and St Laurence O'Toole, bishop

SENIORS TUESDAY CLUB In Fairhill Youth Centre on Tuesdays at 10.30am.

CHAIR PILATES – For over 50's. Classes are FREE. 4 weeks course in Fairhill Youth Club, starting on Thursday 12 November at 10.15am. Tutor: Rebecca Williamson

GLEN GAA Website www.wattygrahamsgac.com Lotto Numbers 37:32:36:49: No winner, next week Jackpot £15,000. Three £50 winners: Niamh Glass, Faolan McEldowney and Ryan & Jamie Duggan. Flyover £17,000 in 45 Nos or less.

FALLAGHLOON HALL - BINGO- Sunday night 7.30pm. Jackpot £500 in 45 numbers.

BRACKAGH HALL - 45-CARDS -continues in Brackagh Hall on Mon 2 Nov. at 7.30pm.

CLG Sleacht Neil – REMEMBRANCE MASS on Thurs 12 Nov at 7.30pm in Slaughtneil Hall. **Cooking classes and nutrition workshops** with the "Sporty Dietician" in Slaughtneil Hall on Tues 10th, 17th, 24th November at 6.30pm to 8.30pm. Spaces limited. Tel. Donna 075188857. **SLAUGHTNEIL BING0** on Saturday - 14 November at 8pm. Usual prizes

Rainey Street, on Monday 23 Nov at 10am. Kindly let us know if you have any dietary requirements.

FATIMA PILGRIMAGE – Fully escorted group pilgrimage to Fatima accompanied by Spiritual Director, 28 June-5 July 2027. Direct Daytime Flights from Belfast to Porto. Return Staying in 4* `hotel. Full Board. Services of JWT Pilgrimage Guide. Daily Mass and Spiritual Activities. Cost: £975pps. Early Booking Offer: £100 off if paid in full by 30 November 2026. For further details, please Contact Christine Lagan: 07803192621.

ABIDE WOMEN'S CONFERENCE, November 20th-22nd – The Great Northern Hotel Bundoran, Co. Donegal. Speakers include Sarah Swafford, Fr. Barry Braum, Fr. Mark Wharton, Kimberlee Wooling, Danielle Noonan, Nashville Dominicans & more. Mass will be celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin, from Cork & Ross Diocese. We would love to welcome you this weekend. For more details, please visit;- Abide in His Love at evenbrite.ie Registration link: htts://abideinhislove.eventbrite.com

TROCAIRE IS LOOKING FOR VOLUNTEERS to help deliver school talks during our annual Lent Appeal during February and March 2027. We are particularly interested in hearing from people with public speaking experience, especially retired teachers or those who have worked with young people. Volunteers will visit local schools during school hours to share stories of hope, justice and solidarity from communities around the world. The role involves approximately 1-2 short talks per week during the four-month campaign period. Full training, presentation materials and ongoing support will be provided. Please contact Fionnuala McGuimmness on 028 9080 8033 or Fionnuala.mcguinness@trocaire.org by the first week of December if you are interested!

THE COLUMBAN YOUNG ADULTS – is a relatively new group for those aged 18-35 in the diocese - on Thurs 19 Nov at 7pm at our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, delivered by recently retired Bishop Donal McKeown. The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and then refreshments. We are actively seeking new members, please come along and bring a friend! email: columbanyoungadults@gmail.com or follow us on social media

Thirty-Second Sunday in Ordinary Time

8 November 2026

Oil You Cannot Borrow

Nobody wastes oil these days. Ask anyone who has just filled their car or home heating oil tank. In the 1970s people recall filling the tank without a second thought. Now we watch the gauge and treat every drop as precious. Keep that in mind, because this Sunday's Gospel is about lamps and oil. Last Sunday we looked at the finished picture, the saints. This Sunday asks how you get there.

Ten bridesmaids wait for the bridegroom. He is late. All ten fall asleep, the wise as well as the foolish. Sleep is not the sin. When the shout goes up at midnight, the difference is who has oil. Five do. Five do not, and by the time they buy some, the door is shut.

The oil is the point. It is the one thing in the story that cannot be borrowed. You cannot borrow another person's prayer life, or their habit of forgiving, or their years of coming to Mass when nobody made them. The oil is a life filled a little at a time, long before it is needed.

The first reading calls that oil wisdom and says something consoling. Wisdom is bright, does not fade, and is found by those who look for it. It even comes looking for us. We seek and the Holy Spirit finds and plants those sevenfold gifts in us in Baptism.

November keeps the second reading close. Saint Paul tells people grieving their dead not to grieve as those who have no hope. Jesus died and rose, and it will be the same for those who have died in him. It's not known when the bridegroom is returning, but he is coming.

So, this week, fill the lamp, say the prayer, forgive that one thing. And during the Forty Hours this Sunday and Monday: an hour before the Blessed Sacrament is free oil, there for the taking. A drop at a time, to put in your own tank, so your light may shine later, when needed...

Fr Sean

Announcements

Last week's collections amounted to: ***Melmount:*** £2951.00; ***Sion Mills*****:** £1461.00. Thank you.

Forty Hours *St. Mary's Church, Melmount today Sunday 8 November – Monday 9 November.*

Sunday 8 November 8.00am *Morning Prayer,* 11.30am *Mass,* 3.00pm *Divine Mercy Chaplet*, 6.00pm *Holy Hour: Angelus, Evening Prayer and Stations of the Cross,* 9.00pm *Rosary,* 9.30pm *Night Prayer.*

Monday 9 November 12.00am *Rosary,* 3.00am *Rosary,* 6.00am *Angelus and Chaplet,* 8.00am *Morning Prayer & Rosary*, 10.00am *Mass,* 12.00pm *Angelus and Midday Prayer,* 3.00pm *Divine Mercy Chaplet,* 6.00pm *Angelus and Chaplet*, 8.00pm *Holy Hour: with Evening Prayer and Rosary,* 9.30pm *Night Prayer,* 12.00am *Solemn Benediction to conclude the 40 Hours.*

Legion of Mary will meet in the Green Room, Sion Mills each Monday evening at 7.30pm.

We congratulate the following couple who were recently united in the Sacrament of Marriage:

Holly Swann and Stephen Cairns

May they Rest in Peace

Deaths

Paul Devine, 133 Ballycolman Estate

Judy Doherty, 7 Landsdowne Park

Tommy Murray, 72 Laurel Drive

Celine Connolly, 248 Melmount Road

John McConnell, 15 Derry Road

Philomena MacRory, Omagh

Andy Gormley, Dublin formerly Claudy

Michael McBride, Plumbridge

Maureen Quinn, Stevenage, London

Anniversaries

Fr. Augustine Gillespie, Suzanna Howard, Thomas Howard

Jim Roarty Jnr., Jim O'Donnell, Eamon Coyle

Charlie Nelson, Margaret Nelson, Celine O'Neill

Patsy McGarrigle, Annie Brennan, Mary McNulty

Sean Duffy, Thaddaeus Gamble, John Porter

Louis Farren, Susan Carlin, Emma Walsh

Hugh Donaghey, Charlie McColgan, Marc Harkin

Gerry McMenamin, Kate Ward, Tony Coyle, Molly Finlay

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Annual Service for the Dead The Annual Service in remembrance of deceased members of our families and parish will take place next Sunday, 15 November at 4.00pm in St. Mary's Church, Melmount and at 6.00pm in St. Theresa's Church, Sion Mills. Families who have suffered a

bereavement since November 2025 are asked to nominate a representative to carry a candle to the altar in commemoration of their dead. *(Candles will be provided).*

Vocations During this month of November let us pray for the deceased priests who served our diocese and our parishes as we pray for the men who will take up their mantle in the years to come.

There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, today Sunday 8 November beginning at 4.00pm. For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr. Pat O'Hagan at
Pgoh2111@Gmail.Com
or by calling 028 79386259.

Parish Draw Promoters should make their returns for November to the Parish Office on **Monday 16 November from 2.00pm - 4.30pm.** The Draw for November will take place on Thursday 19 November at 10.30am in the Parish Office.

Baptism Dates Melmount

November: Saturday 14, 21 & 28.

December: Saturday 12; Sunday 20.

Baptisms will be at 3.30pm on a Saturday and 12.45pm on a Sunday.

Accord Marriage Preparation Courses 2027 (Pre-Marriage Courses) will take place in January 29/30; February 19/20 and March 19/20. All courses are now online for booking at
Www.Accordni.Com
Please Note: These courses are in person and not online courses.

Pilgrimage to Fatima 5 July 2027 for 7 Nights Led by *Spiritual Director:* Fr Sean O'Donnell. *Group Leader:* Patricia Moore. For booking and more information contact Patricia Moore 07743936548 or Anne McCambridge 07784953408.

Volunteers are Required one morning per month to help with Eucharistic Adoration for St. Mary's P.S. children as part of the Children of the Eucharist (COTE) programme. Safeguarding requirements apply. If you would like to get involved, please leave your contact details with the Parish Office.

The Columban Young Adults

is a relatively new group for those aged 18yrs – 35yrs in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Our November event will be a Holy Hour and meditation on Thursday 19 November at 7.00pm in Our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry delivered by recently retired Bishop Donal McKeown. The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and then refreshments. We are actively seeking new members – please come along and bring a friend. For any further information please contact us at Columbanyoungadults@Gmail.Com
or follow us on social media.

Managing Grief at Christmas Time – Free Support Workshops Christmas can be an especially difficult time when grieving the loss of a loved one. Road Victim Support Northern Ireland–Donegal invites anyone experiencing grief to join us for a free, donation-based workshop, facilitated by Counsellor Debbie Mullan. These welcoming and supportive workshops offer practical tools for coping with grief, managing difficult emotions, navigating Christmas traditions and finding meaningful ways to remember loved ones. Open to everyone who has experienced bereavement, regardless of the circumstances of their loss. Wednesday 18 November: The Hub, Cookstown, 7pm–9pm. Free to attend – optional donations welcome. For further information and booking call 077 48570558. You don't have to navigate grief alone this Christmas. Everyone is warmly welcome.

Derry Diocesan Pilgrimage to Lourdes 2027, led by Bishop Michael Router There are two options available as follows: *Option 1:* 8 - 13 July, 5 nights, £980, from City of Derry Airport, with priority given to Assisted Pilgrims and family members, Care Team, Youth, Youth Leaders and

Priests. *Option 2:* 7 - 14 July, 7 nights, £1,095, from Belfast International Airport. Single Supplement and Travel Insurance will be extra. If interested email

Derrypilgrim@Outlook.Com

Bookings will begin in mid-January, with more details later. Pilgrimage Gift Vouchers of any value are available from the Pastoral Centre, Bishop Street, Derry, for anyone wishing to purchase them, particularly as a Christmas Gift. For further information contact 028 7136 2475.

Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email@

Dlp@Derrydiocese.Org

Northern Ireland emergency services: PSNI on 101; *Social Services:* Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 71314090 and ask for the Duty Social Worker. *Regional Emergency* Social Work Services 0800 1979 995.